

There is a reason why mathematics is called “the queen of all the sciences”. It is an essential component of a number of other disciplines, making its deep understanding a remarkable skill. Being able to combine it with real-life situations has always fascinated me, and hence IBEB seemed like a perfect choice for my undergraduate studies. It is a degree in economics with a strong emphasis on mathematics. Yet, another and probably even more important reason for this choice had to do with my natural curiosity and a goal-oriented personality. I never wanted to follow the path created by others and always tried to find my own, unique way. That is why, unlike most of my family and friends, I decided to step out of my comfort zone and continue my studies abroad. My life has always been full of tests and difficult decisions. All of them, however, not only taught me how to quickly adapt to new, demanding environments, but also served as reassurance that through my determination and ambition, I am always able to achieve my goals, no matter how unrealistic they may seem. Ability to deal with difficult situations and a constant pursuit of personal growth are the reasons why I believe I will succeed at Imperial College London.

Obviously, my belief in me being a suitable candidate for this course is also backed by my previous academic performance. During the course of my studies, I excelled at heavily quantitative courses, such as Mathematics, Statistics and Microeconomics, but I also never neglected the remaining subjects. My excellent academic accomplishments granted me a Cum Laude award after my first year of studies, showing that I was one of the best students of the whole course. This was a main steppingstone to land my teaching assistant position for Mathematics, where I was to instruct first-year students in tutorials, as well as being involved in exam-related matters. Additionally, I became a tutor for Microeconomics, conducting recap and exam preparatory classes. These positions were crucial for my academic development, as they helped enhance my understanding of various mathematical concepts through explaining them to first-year students. Even though my schedule was always busy, I still managed to find time for a variety of extracurricular activities. I became an active member of the Eastern European Student Association (EESA) and Erasmus Volley (EV). That, combined with my eagerness to constantly deepen my knowledge, allowed me to significantly develop both academically and personally.

Before starting my bachelor’s degree, I decided to take a gap year in China where my main focus was learning Mandarin. That was one of the most challenging, yet valuable experiences of my life, as it not only opened me to new cultures, but also triggered my passion towards Chinese language, which I continued developing throughout the whole course of my undergraduate studies. That was also the reason why I chose Shanghai as the destination for my exchange

during the first semester of my final year, as it helped me reach fluency in Mandarin, as well as become a more open-minded and culturally aware person.

Trying to apply the knowledge I gained at my university, I decided to take up an internship position at Whale Bay & Co, a financial valuations company. I spent there the last 3 months of my second year and will continue working there after I come back from my exchange. This position helped me gain valuable work experience, as I was able to use my mathematical skills to perform financial analyses and valuations. Additionally, the last month of my internship I spent on developing a valuation computing program using the VBA function in Excel.

The reason why I believe Risk Management and Financial Engineering is a perfectly suited course for me is because it implements extremely sophisticated mathematics and software-based skills into the rapidly changing financial world. My interest in these areas makes me especially excited about courses such as Data Structures and Algorithms using Python, or Application of R for Finance. They will be also immensely valuable for my future career because I am aspiring to enter the sector of quantitative finance. Advanced mathematical knowledge and understanding of programming languages, like Python and R, are crucial to succeed in this field. Studying this prestigious course at Imperial College Business School, one of the top business schools in the world, would give me a phenomenal foundation to start my career after graduating. University's location also highly influenced my decision, as it is situated in the center of one of the most vibrant cities in the world and the financial capital of Europe. Additionally, Imperial College Business School Careers allows students to benefit from advice on recruitment and helps them swiftly launch their careers after graduating. That is highly valuable to me, as I am hoping to continue my career in London, with quantitative analyst currently being my most desired path of future employment.

A vast array of extracurricular activities, joined with a constant pursuit of intellectual growth, helped me develop excellent work ethics and time management skills. Being one of the top performing students at my university, combined with my ambitious personality, makes me certain that I am a perfect candidate for this position. I am determined to contribute to your community with a mind open to new ideas and motivation to become an expert in Risk Management and Financial Engineering.